

flower, so people could take them home and plant them, knowing they would come up every year.

3. Handmade

I'm not just talking tea cozies here. This could be anything from a set of designer-style drapes, to a custom paint job in your living room, to a hand-done mural. Are you great at Web design, or data management? If you have a skill that people would routinely pay for, then chances are somebody would appreciate receiving a gift that benefited from them.

4. Engraved, refillable pens

Use for graduations, new jobs, anniversaries, etc. These are really classy and special gifts that people will use. Think of all the cheap plastic pen casings that won't be out there in the landfills!

5. Green consumable products

Think fair trade coffee, soy-based candles, or eco-friendly bath products. This goes back a bit to the first item. When people are on a budget, they don't necessarily feel comfortable indulging in treats. They're affordable, and support the environment and small vendors.

6. Repurpose family heritage

Look through your attic and find things connected to your family history. Repurpose them. Turn an item of clothing from a grandparent into several smaller treasures for younger family members. Digitally archiving old family photos so everyone can enjoy them is another cool strategy that blends family history with newer technology, like digital photo frames.

— **Myscha Theriault**

A Simple How-To Guide to Regifting

We've all been there. You open a present with giddy anticipation, ripping the gift wrap away like a 10-year-old on a sugar high. And then, as you open the box and peek inside, your brain searches for a way to act really happy . . . because the gift you have received is just, well, awful. And when the dust settles and the event is over, it's time to start